increased production of sporting goods and the construction of new stadiums.

From this time – the early 50s – the threat from the West was to be Honecker's theme to the exclusion of almost everything else. As world events shook the foundations of ordered society, US President, Harry S. Truman, prepared the development of the hydrogen bomb in response to the detonation of the Soviet Union's first atomic explosive device. In Europe, a joint declaration by America, Britain and France amounted to a virtual guarantee of German security, when it was announced that any attack on West Germany would be considered by them as an attack on the so-called 'Big Three'.

Furthermore, Paris, London and Washington ended the state of war with Germany and permitted the formation of a West German Ministry of Foreign Affairs, which could establish embassies abroad. From here on, the outward look of the FDJ adopted a much more militaristic tone – marching in columns, carrying flags, and discipline on parade became the norm. Honecker sent his young warriors to help fan anti-Western flames in Heligoland, a small archipelago in the North Sea, where squatters forced the British Royal Air Force to abandon target practice. The situation was reddened by Prince Hubertus Loewenstein, a nationalist campaigner, who claimed the RAF was a menace to Germans and cited a series of incidents, one being the crash of an RAF Hornet fighter into a house in Dusseldorf. Honecker fuelled anti-British sentiment by encouraging author Peter Martin Lampel to write a play about the struggle. When first performed, Kampf um Heligoland was a far greater success than any of its participants anticipated. Over time, the theatre became a fruitful place for the FDJ to spread its message. Honecker persuaded Gustav von Wangenheim to write a Whitsun play which, he recalled, 'proved that an artist can be inspired by such a commission if it agrees with his own basic aims. In fact, when staged, the play Du bist der Richtige (You are the Right One) enjoyed considerable success.'5

Buoyed by such triumphs, he personally prepared a highly choreographed all-German youth gathering in Berlin, where 700,000 'young peace fighters' joined together in one of the mightiest demonstrations the capital